

✦ THE SOUL SPACE ✦

The Trigger Card™

By Sonali Badani

One page. Three lines.
For the three seconds before you say
the thing you always say.

THIS CARD BELONGS TO

name

BONUS TWO · HOW IT WORKS

How To Actually Use It

Print the next page. Cut it out. Stick it somewhere only you will see it. Inside a cupboard door, behind the wardrobe door, on the inside of the bathroom cabinet. Not on the fridge, where it becomes a conversation with somebody else.

DO NOT USE IT IN THE MIDDLE OF A FIGHT

Nobody reads a card in the middle of a fight. Use it in the ninety seconds afterwards, when you have walked into the other room. Write the three lines while it is still hot. That is when the pattern is still visible.

SIX WORDS FOR THE TRIGGER, NO MORE

The moment you write more than six words you have stopped describing what happened and started building a case. He came home and did not ask about my day. That is the trigger. He never cares about anything I do is not a trigger, that is the pattern talking.

NAME THE PATTERN HONESTLY

Most women find they have between two and four patterns, and they run in every argument regardless of the subject. I go quiet and wait for him to notice. I bring up something from four years ago. I explain myself three more times. I become extremely busy and extremely polite. Name yours in your own words, even if the words are not flattering.

THE THIRD LINE IS THE WHOLE THING

The question is not what would end this argument. It is what response would create the relationship I say I want. Those are two completely different questions and they almost always have different answers. The first one keeps the peace today. The second one changes what your house feels like in a year.

YOU WILL USE IT LATE FOR THE FIRST TWO WEEKS

That is normal and it still counts. In week one most women write the card an hour after the argument. By week three it moves to a few minutes afterwards. Somewhere around week four it starts arriving while it is happening, and that is the day the pattern stops running the house.

PRINT THIS PAGE · CUT ALONG THE BOX · PUT IT WHERE ONLY YOU WILL SEE IT

The Trigger Card

Three seconds. That is all this needs.

1 · TRIGGER

**What just happened? Say it in six words.
Not what it means. Just what happened.**

2 · PATTERN

**What am I about to automatically do?
Name it. You already know its name.**

3 · CHOICE

**What response would create the marriage I say I want?
Do that one instead.**

**I am not the reaction. I have one.
And I can watch it happening.**

Sonali Badani · The Soul Space · Marriage by Chance. Love Legacy by Choice.

BONUS TWO · THREE REAL ONES

Three Real Ones

These are the shapes I see most often. Yours will not look exactly like any of them.

ONE

Trigger	He came home, ate, went to his phone.
Pattern	I got busy and polite. Very polite. Loudly polite.
Choice	I could have sat down and said, I have had a long day and I would like ten minutes with you. Not a complaint. A request.

TWO

Trigger	He said, why is this always such a big deal.
Pattern	I explained myself three more times, louder each time.
Choice	I could have said, it is a big deal to me and I want you to know why, and then said it once and stopped.

THREE

Trigger	He went quiet after dinner.
Pattern	I decided his quiet was about me and went colder than he was.
Choice	I could have let his quiet be his. It is allowed to be about his day, his father, his work, and nothing to do with me at all.

Look at the third line in all three. Not one of them is a technique, a script, or a clever sentence. Each one is a woman doing something other than the automatic thing. That is the entire skill, and it is trainable.

BONUS TWO · YOUR FIRST FOUR

Your First Four

Fill one in each time it happens this week. Four is enough to see your own pattern with your own eyes.

CARD ONE

Trigger	
Pattern	
Choice	

CARD TWO

Trigger	
Pattern	
Choice	

BONUS TWO · YOUR FIRST FOUR

Cards Three And Four

Same three lines. Trigger, pattern, choice.

CARD THREE

Trigger	
Pattern	
Choice	

CARD FOUR

Trigger	
Pattern	
Choice	

BONUS TWO · END OF THE WEEK

At The End Of The Week

Read your four cards one after another and look only at the middle line. Almost everybody finds the same pattern written four different ways.

› **Write it here in one sentence, in your own words.**

Write freely

That sentence is the thing you have been trying to fix from the outside for years. Now you can see it.

Awareness creates choice.

You cannot choose something you cannot see, and you cannot see a pattern while you are inside it. This card puts one small gap between the thing that happens and the thing you do next. That gap is where everything else becomes possible.